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MUSIC

LOVE CONQUERS

IKKA's third album *Only Love Gets Reply* brings together bigwigs like Diljit Dosanjh, Badshah and Karan Aujla, among others

Rapper Ankit Singh Patyal, better known as IKKA, can easily be called the 'poster boy' of Indian hip-hop. Whether it was his last two albums *Nishu* or *I*, or popular chartbusters in Bollywood films like *Badrinath ki Dulhania*, the artiste has cracked the code to success.

While hip-hop remains his forte, he has attempted to offer his audiences a new flavour with his third album *Only Love Gets Reply* with T-Series. "This time around, I have tried to maintain a balance between commercial and hip-hop through my art. There is something for everyone," he shares.

What's more, IKKA has collaborated with big names like Diljit Dosanjh, Guru Randhawa, Badshah, Sunidhi Chauhan and Karan Aujla, among others, on this album. "I am so thankful that all the artistes who have contributed to *Only Love Gets Reply* have blessed my tracks with their art. Each of these artistes are pioneers in the industry and their presence is enough to create a huge impact on the album," he says.

But why did he decide on this particular name for the album? "The thought behind the album struck me because of the hatred I've witnessed on social media. I believe hate never takes one far and should be ignored. When you communicate with love, you only get love," adds IKKA.

Only Love Gets Reply has 10 tracks, out of which 'Laadla' and 'Urvashi' featuring MC Stan were released in November 2023. IKKA's next 'House of Lies' featuring Aujla released on May 24 while the other songs will take a few months.

As someone who began his hip-hop journey many years ago, IKKA believes the industry has witnessed a transformation, with more creative tracks being released today. "From young guns to the pioneers of the industry, everyone is looking to do something fresh. Look at Badshah *bhai* collaborating with J Balvin or King with Jason Derulo. I am sure we will see many more such collaborations in the coming years."

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Is that something that's also on his mind? "Certainly. I also believe collaborating with international artistes is a good idea to spread our music across borders. I collaborated with Dope D.O.D. on my previous album. I am open to joining hands with more such forces in music if a suitable collaboration comes my way," he concludes. ■

–Geetika Sachdev